

underneath and around vehicles, tracking moving objects usually hidden from the human eye.”

The company plans to bring its cars on the road as a ride-hailing service, in which riders can hail one of the company's autonomous minivans via an app like Uber or Lyft. “People will get to use our fleet of on-demand vehicles, to do anything from commute to work, get home from a night out, or run errands,” Krafcik said.

While other autonomous vehicle companies are still working with safety drivers, Waymo has abandoned their training wheels in order to rise ahead of the competition.

Smart motorways that beam live traffic news to cars

Fibre-optic cables running along Britain's busiest motorways will be able to beam live traffic updates into high-tech cars under new proposals by Highways England. Messages will be transmitted onto dashboards in a move to improve the efficiency of how major routes operate while also improving road safety. The connected vehicles will also be programmed to spot potholes and transmit the information to road operators.



Fibre-optic cables are the latest step in upgrading Britain's major roads into smart motorways (Credit: Dave Thompson/PA)

The development is the latest step in upgrading Britain's major roads into smart motorways. The way messages are displayed is another step away from using traditional road signs. Highways England hopes that improving Wi-Fi and 5G connectivity across the UK motorways will help it to prepare for driverless cars.

Las Vegas casino using microwaves to keep guns out

The Westgate Las Vegas Resort and Casino is testing a discreet weapon-sensing device called the Patscan cognitive microwave radar. Marketed by Canadian security outfit PatriotOne, the Patscan CMR combines short-range radar with machine learning algorithms to scan individual guests for guns, knives and bombs in real time—without forcing them to line up and walk through metal detectors. And unlike the giant, whole-body scanners you see in places like airports, Patscan units are small enough to hide inside existing infrastructure like walls and doorways.



PatriotOne's Patscan cognitive microwave radar is small enough to hide inside existing infrastructure like walls and doorways

A system like PatriotOne's could be the ideal security solution for a destination like Las Vegas, where resorts find themselves struggling to ensure the safety of their guests, while also stoking an ambiance of freedom.

Each radar unit in Patscan consists of a service box and two antennae. The first antenna emits 1000 pulses of electromagnetic radiation per second, at frequencies between 500MHz and 5GHz. The second antenna monitors for electromagnetic patterns inside that two-metre range. When you hit an object with electromagnetic radiation, it resonates according to its shape and material composition.

“We call it an object's radar signature,” says electrical engineer Natalia Nikolova, director of McMaster University's Electromagnetic Vision Research Laboratory. PatriotOne maintains a growing database of known radar signatures, which Patscan's onboard computer uses to distinguish weapons from benign objects and notify security personnel.

Facebook admits that social media is bad for us

With people spending more time on social media, many have started wondering whether that is good for us. According to Statista, on an average, people spent 135 minutes a day on social media in 2017.



Thumbs down: The average Internet user spends 135 minutes per day on social media